Proofroom

Verified Team & Financing briefs for startup investors

Type a startup's website domain. Proofroom finds its funding announcement and its founders, checks each claim about the team and the money raised against Crustdata's company and people records and the original source, and hands back a short brief an investor can paste into a memo. Every sentence points to its evidence, and every limit is stated plainly.

Track	Investing: analysing startups (ContextCon IIT Bombay, Agentic Services Hackathon)
Input	A company domain, for example *koahlabs.com*. Optionally: a deck or article, the people to check, a meeting date and a focus note.
Output	A Team & Financing brief with cited sentences, a founder table, a funding cross-check, questions to ask and a list of what could not be checked.
Time	Target: a finished brief in about a minute and a quarter, with no human steps.

The problem

Before every founder meeting, someone at a fund checks the same basic facts by hand. Who are the founders, and did they really work where the deck says? How much was raised, when, and who led the round? That means an hour of open tabs: the company's blog, the investor's post, news coverage, professional profiles and funding databases.

The sources don't make it easy:

- A funding announcement is the company's own statement. The lead investor's post about the same round is **not** a second, independent confirmation.
- News sites copy each other, re-date old stories, and report the same round in different currencies.
- Profiles are written by the people themselves, and a sentence like “the founders worked at A, B and C” is often true for only one of them.
- A round, a total, a valuation and a sale of existing shares are easy to mix up.

A chatbot that searches and summarises will happily repeat the press release, which is exactly the thing the investor is trying to check.

What Proofroom is

Proofroom is an autonomous research assistant for one narrow, high-value job: checking the **team** and **financing** facts about a private startup. It does the associate's research, checking and first draft end to end, and stops at facts. It does not give investment advice.

Each claim in the brief gets a plain-English status:

Status	What it tells the reader
Supported	The evidence says this, and the brief says who said it (the company, the investor or an independent report).
Supported, corrected	True only with a correction, such as a different date, a narrower scope or a different title. The correction is spelled out.
Conflicting	Comparable sources disagree. Both are shown.
Not established	The evidence neither supports nor contradicts it. A gap, not a red flag.
Not checked	Out of scope (for example revenue claims) or not selected, with the reason.

Alongside the statuses, the brief shows where each fact came from: a company statement, an investor statement, an independent report, Crustdata's indexed record, or a calculation.

Who will use it

User	Their job	What Proofroom gives them
VC associate or analyst (primary user)	Prepares the partner for founder meetings and writes the first investment memo.	The Team & Financing section, already checked and cited, ready to paste into the memo.
Investment partner	Walks into the meeting and decides whether to go deeper.	A one-page view of what holds up, what needs qualifying, and the questions worth asking.
Fund platform or research team	Screens many inbound startups each week.	A fast, consistent first pass on dozens of companies, with honest gaps flagged.
Angel investors and syndicate leads	Invest without an analyst team behind them.	Associate-grade checking from just a company's website address.
Accelerator and venture studio teams	Review applications and portfolio updates.	A quick check that founder backgrounds and prior funding match what applicants report.
Corporate venture and partnerships teams	Vet startups before investing, partnering or acquiring.	A cited record of who the founders are and what the company has raised.

Demand from these groups is a hypothesis to test after the hackathon, not a measured result.

Use cases

1. Founder-meeting preparation

An associate has a meeting with a startup tomorrow. They type the domain and the meeting date. Proofroom returns the founders, their current roles and past employers, the latest round with its lead investor, and two or three questions for the meeting.

2. Checking a pitch deck's claims

A founder sends a deck saying “ex-Google team, $5M seed led by a top fund”. The associate pastes the deck text. Proofroom checks each team and funding claim and marks which ones hold, which need a correction, and which can't be confirmed.

3. First-pass screening of inbound deals

A platform team receives a long list of startups. Running each domain gives a consistent Team & Financing snapshot, so people spend their time on the companies that deserve it.

4. Writing the investment memo

The checked sentences go straight into the memo with their citations, so a partner or the investment committee can click through to the exact passage or record behind each statement.

5. Spotting overstated team claims

Example from a development test case (not a live demo): an investor's post said a startup's three founders had all overlapped at three earlier companies. Proofroom marked this *Supported, corrected*: the records show those three employers for only one founder. It suggested asking which founders worked where. This is a qualification, not an accusation.

6. Avoiding funding mix-ups

Example from a development test case: a company's reported "total raised" included a sale of existing shares to new investors, which is not new money for the company. Proofroom keeps rounds, totals, valuations and share sales apart, so the memo doesn't overstate the capital raised.

How people use it

Step	What the user does	What they see
1. Ask	Types the startup's domain. Optionally adds a deck or article, names, a meeting date and a focus note (for example "focus on the CTO").	The request is accepted.
2. Watch	Nothing: Proofroom works on its own.	The page fills in as it goes: first the company it identified, then the founders it found, then the claims being checked.
3. Read	Reads the brief.	Cited sentences with statuses, the founder table, the funding cross-check, questions to ask, what wasn't checked, and the limitations.
4. Verify	Clicks any sentence or table cell.	The exact passage or record behind it, with its dates.
5. Use	Downloads the brief.	A ready-to-paste brief document and a structured case file for the fund's own records.

Investors can also try Proofroom without any accounts or keys: a **Load demo case** button replays saved example companies, clearly labelled as replays.

What the brief contains

- **Header:** the company, the date, and whether the run was live or a labelled replay.
- **From the sources:** reusable sentences, each with its status, who said it, and its citations.
- **From Crustdata's records:** a founder table (current role at this company and matched past employers) and a funding cross-check (rounds, amounts, dates and lead investors).
- **Questions** worth raising in the meeting.
- **Not checked** and **Limitations**, so nobody mistakes silence for confirmation.
- **Evidence list:** every source and record used, with when it was published, updated and retrieved.

Why investors can trust it

- **Nothing without evidence.** Every sentence cites its source, and every number and date is checked against that source before the brief is released.
- **Honest about uncertainty.** A missing record is reported as a gap, never as proof that something is false. Profiles are labelled as self-reported.
- **No double counting.** A company's post and its investor's post about the same round count as one announcement, and copies of a story count once.
- **Clear labels.** Every result says whether it is live or a saved replay, and failed attempts are kept, not hidden.

What it does not do

Proofroom does not give investment advice or valuations. It does not verify revenue, customers or headcount, score authenticity, read scanned documents, or contact anyone. It is built for private startups; for large public companies it returns a narrower brief and says so.

> **In one line**
>
> Type a domain and get a Team & Financing brief in which every sentence is tied to a real company and person record and an exact source, every limit is stated, and every number can be checked.